

Bence Bétéri

Pre-Event Report



2026 6 hours of Spa-Francorchamps



01

Track Study

Spa-Francorchamps track study

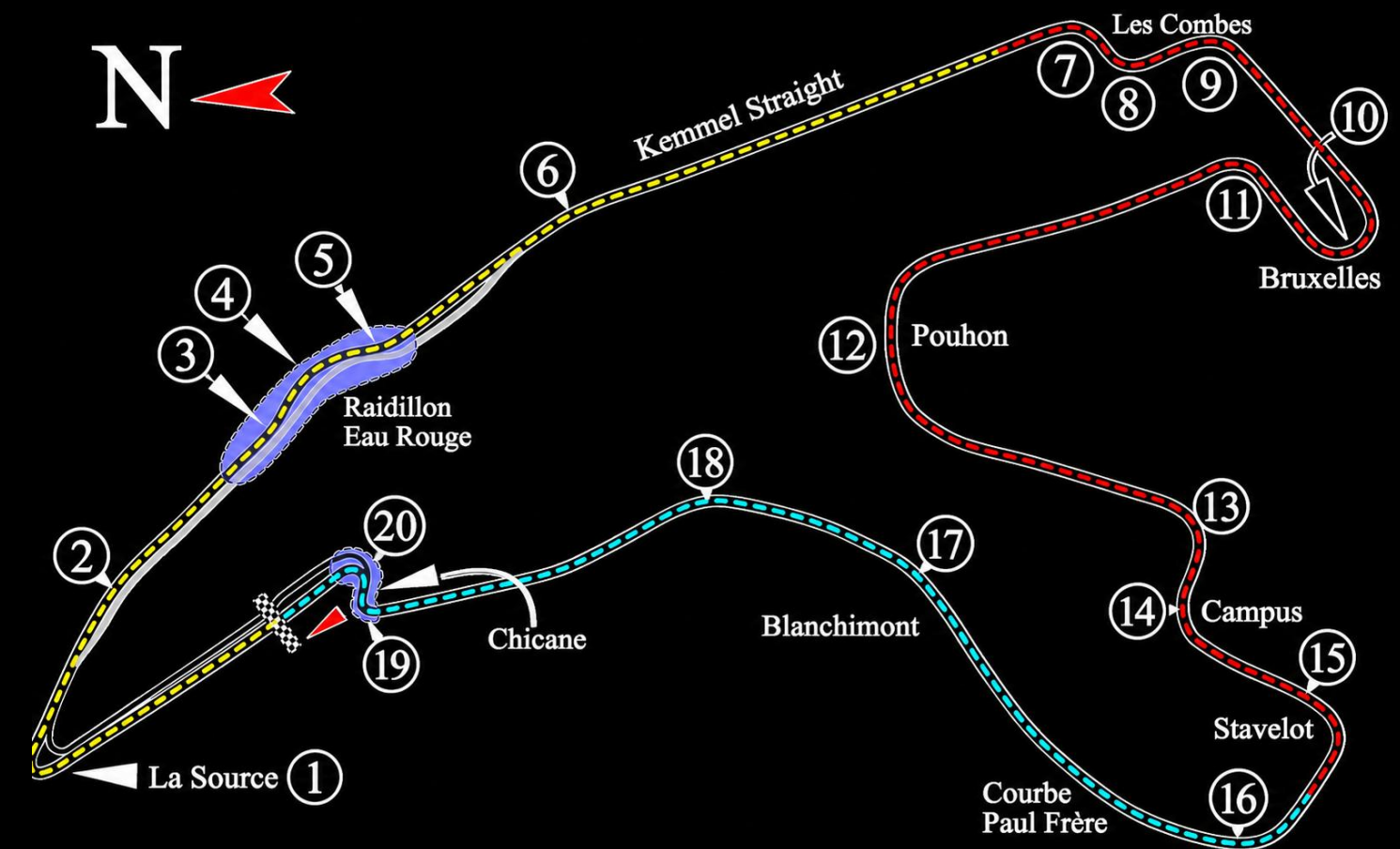


Main Metrics:

- Length: 7004 m, **2nd longest** track on calendar
- Elevation: 102 m, **highest on calendar**
- Corners: 20 → Left: 9, Right:10
- Track Direction: Clockwise

Weather:

- Thu: Small periods of **rain** expected
- Fri: **Sunny** morning and **cloudy** afternoon
- Sat: Mostly **cloudy**, with **rain** expected



Track Characterization:

- Effective tyre management and optimal tyre warm-up are critical for peak performance on this circuit
- Grooving of the Kemmel Straight in 2026; Resurfacing in 2024 → from T17 to T2, T4 to T8, T14 to T15
- Straight-line speed and aero stability are crucial, mechanical grip is also important due to high elevation changes

Event specifications



Timetable:

- **Last race before Le Mans → Every information is key for the preparations for the 24h race**
- **2*90min + 1*60min Free Practice; 15min Qualifying 12min Hyperpole; 6hr Race**
- **Scheduling is similar to last year → there will be only 1 Porsche cup series + Legends of Le Mans → Different effects on the track grip levels → Worth listening to the support series drivers interview and feedback**

Safety car & FCY & Pit at Spa:

- **Average Pit Time: 68s**
- **Average laptime behind SC: 5:18.3**
- **Average SC duration in Spa: 3 to 5 laps**
- **Red Flag: There was no red flag in 2025, only in 2024**

2026 Grid:

- **Hypercar:** Compared to last year, instead of 3 Porsches, there are only 2 Genesises → Expected to be slower
- **LMGT3:** Porsche Manthey fields two cars instead of one this year, with the total grid size unchanged.



02

Hypercar Performance & Strategy Overview

Performance & Strategy Overview



Previous Qualification results:

- Qualification P10 time 2025: 2:01.387 (Peugeot TotalEnergies #94 /S. Vandoorne) → 1.615s faster than in 2024
- **Hyperpole P1** time 2025: **1:59.617** (Ferrari AF Corse #50 /A.Fuoco) → **3.490s** faster than in 2024

Previous Race results:

- **2025** winner Ferrari AF Corse #51 → **150 laps** averaging 2:24.4 laptime
- **2024** winner Hertz Team Jota #12 → **141 laps** avg 3:21.7 laptime → because of the lengthy red flag
- **Ideal race laptime** in 2025 was **2:06.4** (3 sec faster than in 2024), in case of LMGT3 traffic this raised to **2:13.1**

Strategy overview:

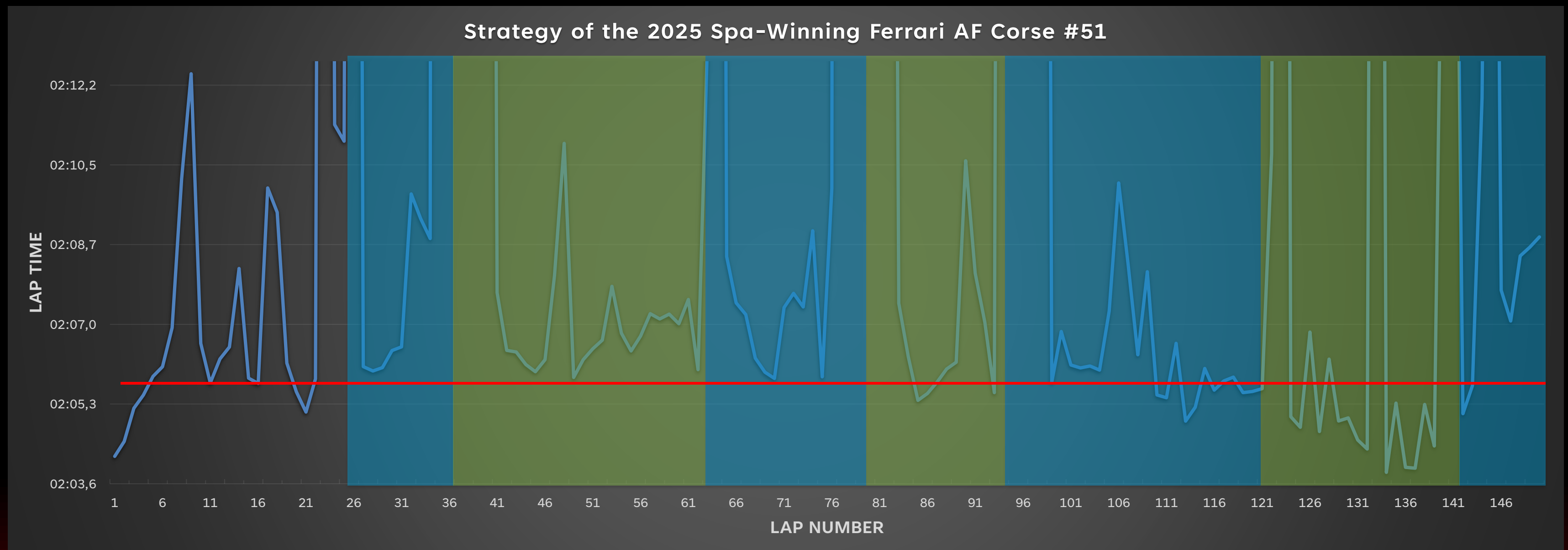
- **Tyre degradation is key** → 2 stints are possible / tyre set. → Higher degradation on the left side
- According to Cadillac's drivers **changing tyres on the left side only was not ideal** → **Unpredictable** reactions from the tyres
- **Fuel consumption** is approximately 4% / lap → **optimal stint ~25 laps**, beyond fuel saving is required.

Performance & Strategy Overview



Strategy of the 2025 Spa-Winning Ferrari AF Corse #51

- Blue stint → Refuel only
- Green stint → Refuel and tyre switch
- Red line → Ideal race lap time



Driver Preparation

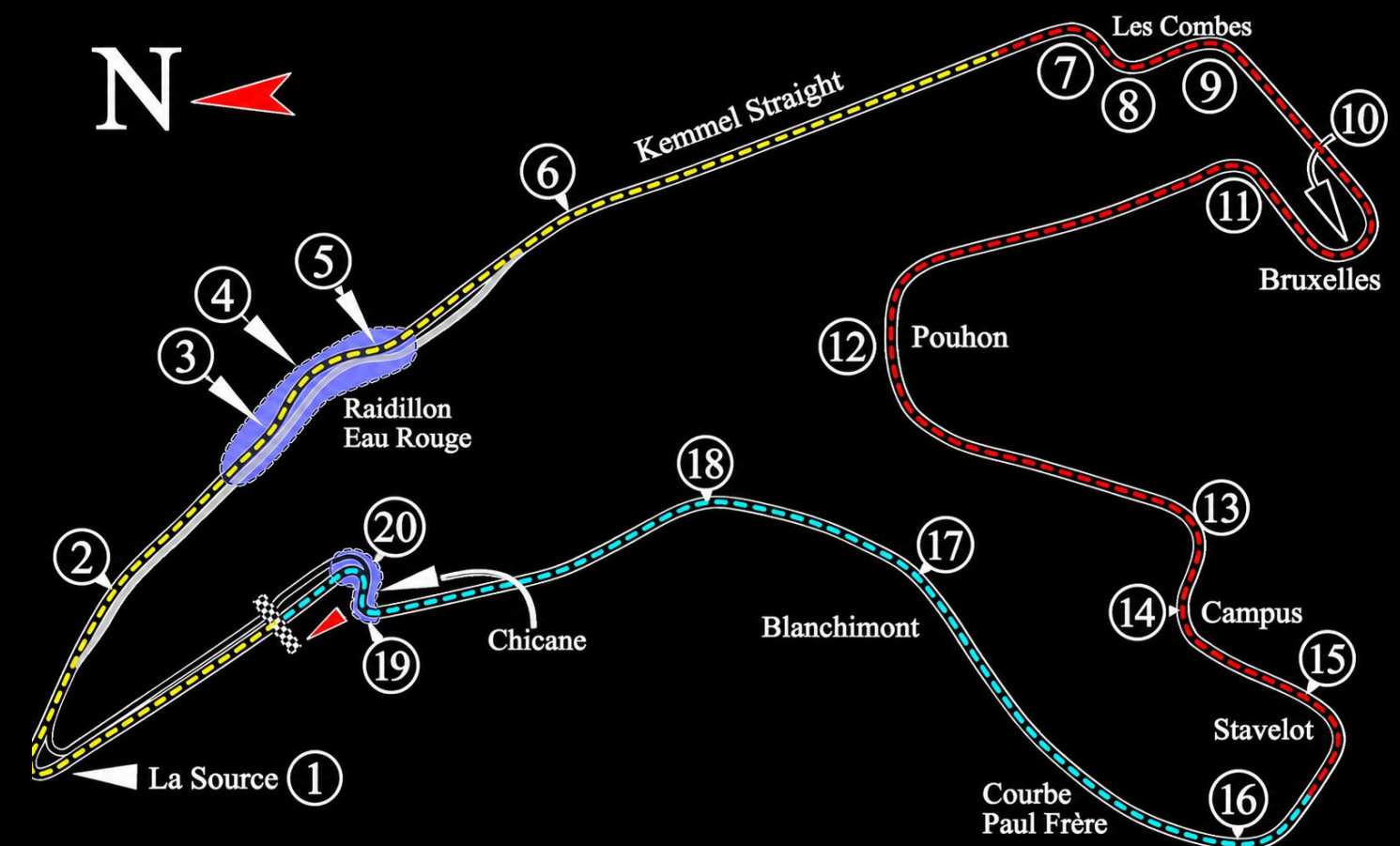


Main Metrics:

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Performance and strategy overview:

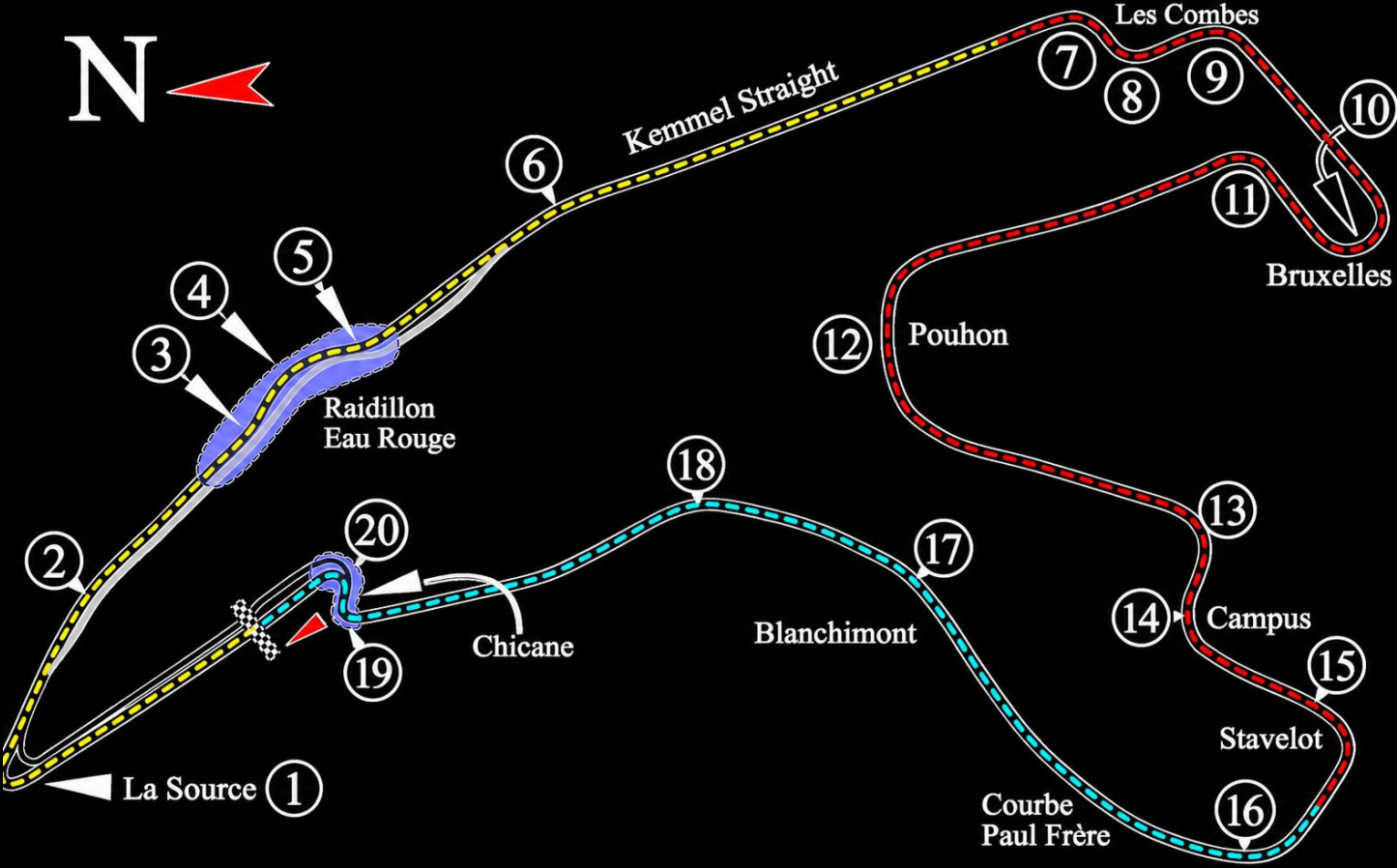
- Tyre management is important → Higher degradation on the left side particularly on the front tyre
- **Changing weather** throughout the week → **Free practice is crucial for car setup**
- Last years average race lap time was **2:06.4**
- Safety car sessions are expected
- Overtaking is possible → No need to crash in L1 T1 → remain calm



Driver Preparation



Turn	Lowest Speed Km/h	Lowest Gear	Comments
1	73	1	Important to come out cleanly at the start
2	240	4	
3	273	6	Try to avoid LMGT3 traffic here, turn exit is crucial for Kemmel straight
4	255	6	
5	262	6	
6	285	6	
7	129	3	Great opportunity to overtake, lot of divebombs here, T7-8-9 are all linked, racing line is vital
8	118	3	
9	155	3	
10	99	2	High elevation change, downhill
11	144	3	
12	182	4	
13	135	3	Important to link them together
14	140	3	
15	127	2	Turn exit is crucial, long straight after
16	209	4	
17	280	6	
18	283	7	
19	74	1	Best opportunity to overtake, heavy braking zone, track limits are strict here
20	72	1	





02

LMGT3 Performance & Strategy

Overview

Performance & Strategy Overview



Previous Qualification results:

- Qualification P10 time 2025: 2:19.757 (Proton Competition #77 /B. Sousa) → 2.728s faster than in 2024
- **Hyperpole P1** time 2025: **2:17.732** (Akkodis ASP Team #78 /F.Gehrsitz) → **3.023s** faster than in 2024

Previous Race results:

- **2025** winner Vista AF Corse #54 → **137 laps** averaging 2:38.8 laptime
- **2024** winner Manthey EMA #12 → **130 laps** avg 3:39.3 laptime → because of the lengthy red flag
- **Ideal race laptime** in 2025 was **2:21.9** (3 sec faster than in 2024), in case of hypercar **traffic** this raised to **2:26.3**

Strategy overview:

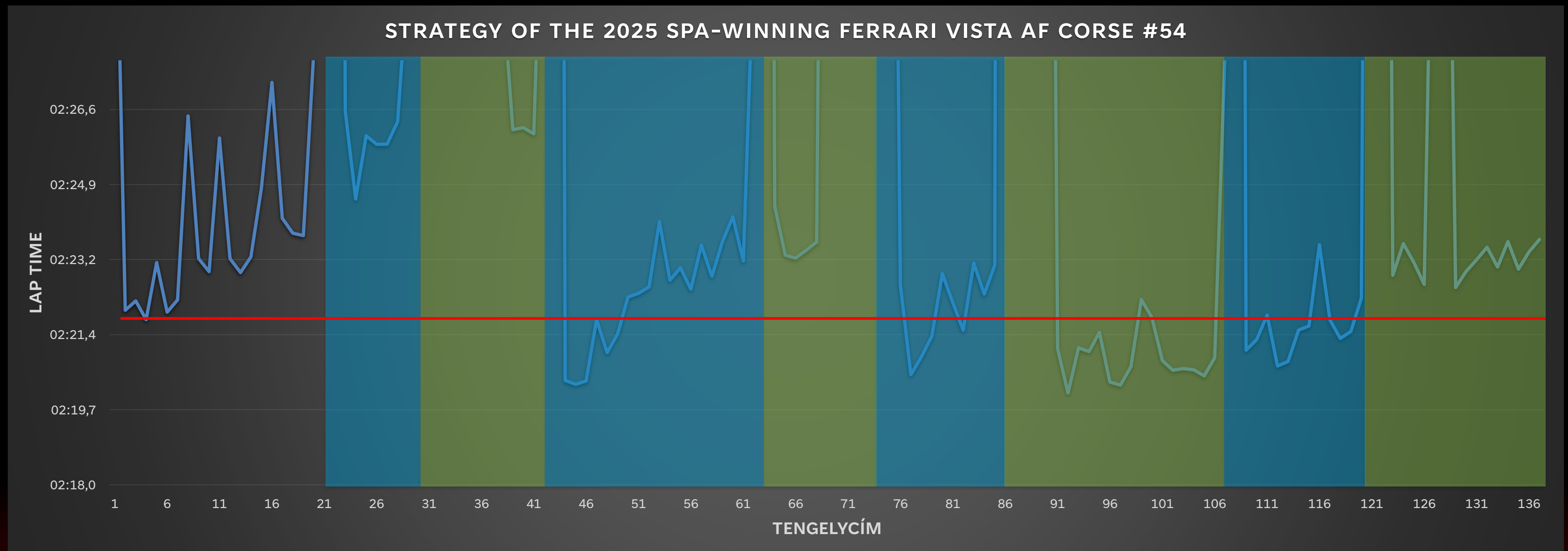
- Tyre degradation is key → 2 stints are possible / tyre set. → Higher degradation on the left side
- Fuel consumption is approximately 4,4% / lap → optimal stint ~22 laps, beyond fuel saving is required.

Performance & Strategy Overview



Strategy of the 2025 Spa-Winning Ferrari Vista AF Corse #54

- Blue stint → Refuel only
- Green stint → Refuel and tyre switch
- Red line → Ideal Race lap time



Driver Preparation

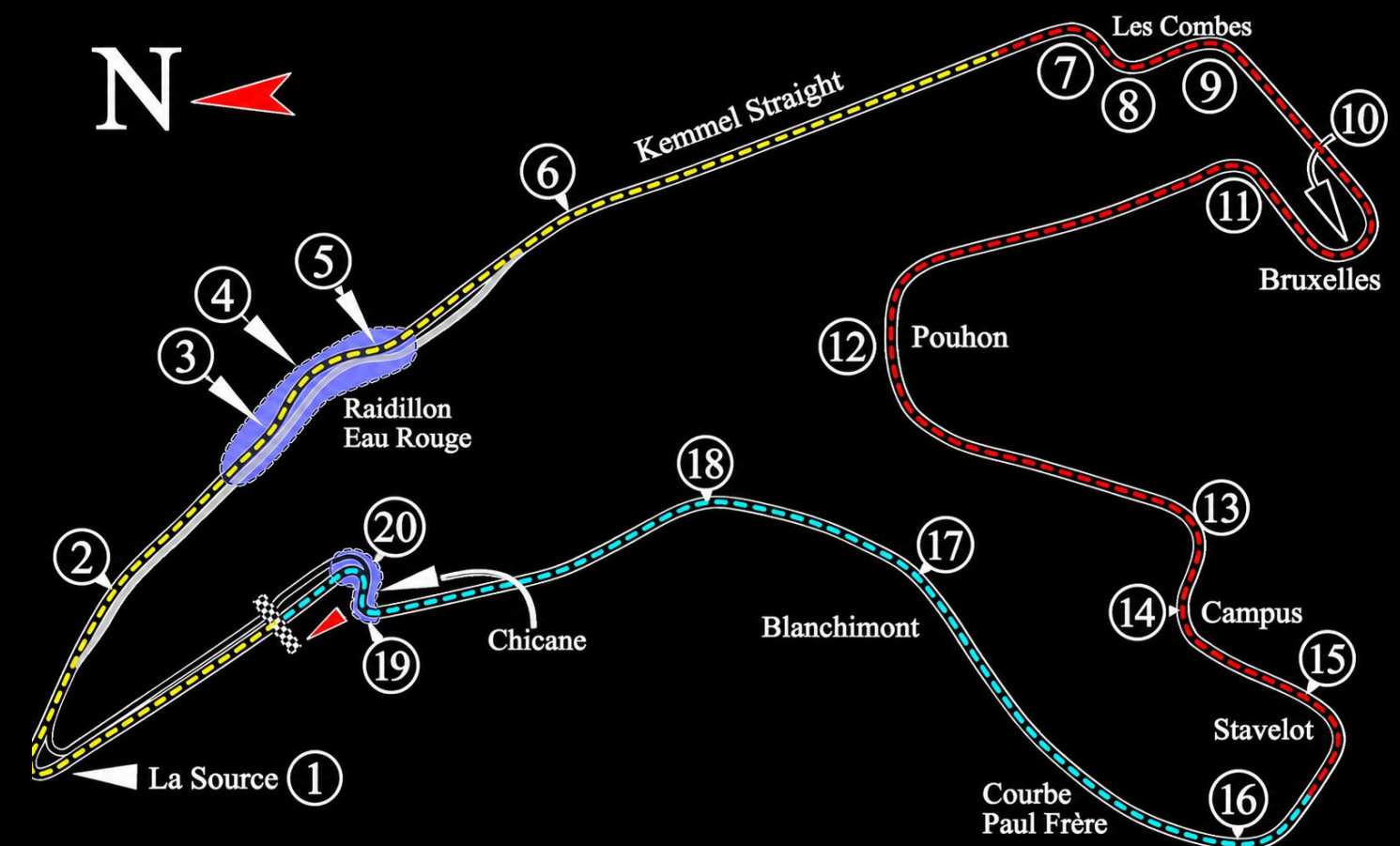


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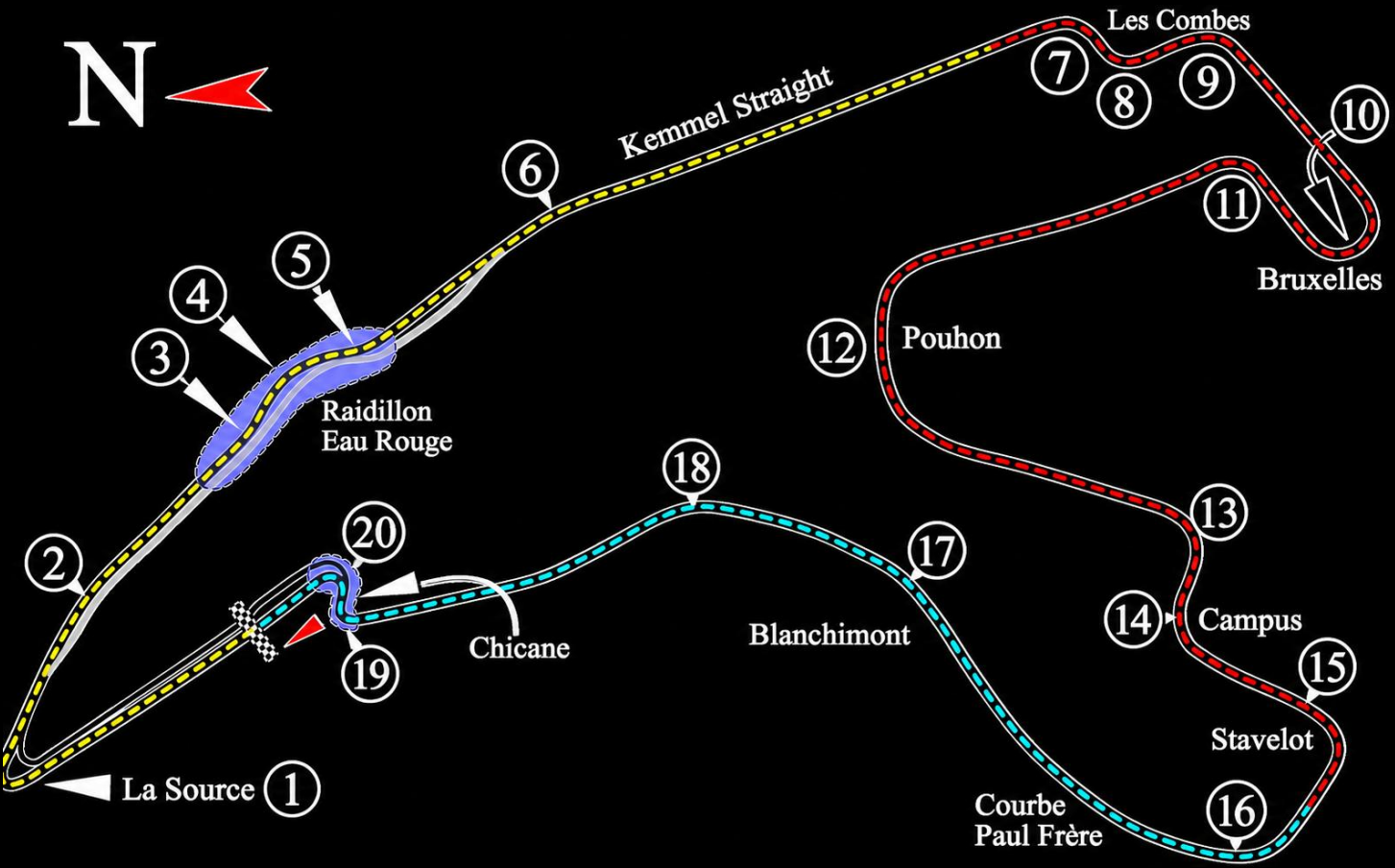
- Tyre management is important → Higher degradation on the left side particularly on the front tyre
- **Changing weather** throughout the week → **Free practice is crucial for car setup**
- Last years average race lap time was **2:21.9**
- Safety car sessions are expected
- Overtaking is possible → No need to crash in L1 T1 → remain calm



Driver Preparation



Turn	Lowest Speed Km/h	Lowest Gear	Comments
1	63	1	Important to come out cleanly at the start
2	180	3	
3	232	5	Try to avoid Hypercar traffic here, turn exit is crucial for Kemmel straight
4	210	5	
5	209	5	
6	227	5	
7	113	2	Great opportunity to overtake, lot of divebombs here, T7-8-9 are all linked, racing line is vital
8	114	2	
9	133	3	
10	83	2	High elevation change, downhill
11	125	3	
12	157	4	
13	115	3	Important to link them together
14	131	3	
15	110	2	Turn exit is crucial, long straight after
16	160	3	Turn exit kerb is rough, try not to use it
17	227	5	
18	236	5	
19	69	1	Best opportunity to overtake, heavy braking zone, track limits are strict here
20	60	1	



Closing Summary



This report covered track characterization, competitor benchmarking, and turn-by-turn driver preparation for both the Hypercar and LMGT3 classes ahead of the 2026 6 Hours of Spa-Francorchamps. It was produced independently, ahead of the event, as a demonstration of a full pre-event analysis workflow rather than commissioned work.